

REMAIN

1. Passage anchor

> “...different classmates had to decide whether to laugh along, ****remain silent**** or speak up.”

Passage meaning

****remain silent**** = continue to be silent; not speak

****保持沉默；繼續不說話****

Here, the students must choose whether to join the laughter, say nothing, or actively speak up.

Practice

1. Several students ****remained silent**** even though they knew something was wrong.

幾名學生明知事情不對，仍然****保持沉默****。

2. She ****remained calm**** during the argument.

她在爭論期間一直****保持冷靜****。

Core meanings of REMAIN

2. remain + adjective — continue in the same state

= continue to be in a particular condition or state

****仍然是；保持……狀態****

Examples

1. Please ****remain calm****.

請****保持冷靜****。

2. The door ****remained open****.

門一直****開著****。

This is the exact passage branch.

3. remain silent

= continue not to speak

****保持沉默；繼續不作聲****

Examples

1. He chose to **remain silent**.
他選擇**保持沉默**。
2. She **remained silent** throughout the discussion.
她整場討論都**沒有作聲**。

4. remain unchanged

= continue to be the same without changing
保持不變

Examples

1. The rules **remain unchanged**.
規則**維持不變**。
2. His opinion **remained unchanged**.
他的看法仍然**沒有改變**。

5. remain unclear / uncertain / unknown

= continue not to be clear, certain, or known
仍不清楚 / 仍不確定 / 仍未知

Examples

1. The cause **remains unclear**.
原因**仍不清楚**。
2. His reasons **remain unknown**.
他的理由**仍然未知**。

Very common formal construction.

Stay in a place

6. remain — stay somewhere

= continue to be in the same place instead of leaving

留下；留在；繼續待在

Examples

1. She **remained in the classroom** after the lesson.

下課後她仍然**留在課室裡**。

2. Please **remain here** until I return.

請**留在這裡**直到我回來。

Major everyday sense.

7. remain at / in / with

= stay in a particular place or situation

留在.....；繼續待在.....

Examples

1. He **remained at home** all day.

他整天都**留在家裡**。

2. Two staff members **remained with the child**.

兩名工作人員繼續**陪著那個孩子**。

Continue to exist

8. remain — continue to exist

= still exist after time has passed or after other things have disappeared

仍然存在；保留下來

Examples

1. Only a few old buildings **remain**.

只剩下幾棟舊建築**仍然存在**。

2. The tradition **remains** today.

這項傳統至今仍然**保留下來**。

9. little / much remains

= a small / large amount still exists or is left

所剩不多 / 仍剩很多

Examples

1. Very little **remains** of the original structure.

原來的建築結構已經**所剩無幾**。

2. Much of the old town **remains**.

老城很大一部分仍然**保存著**。

Be left over

10. remain — be left after others are gone, used, removed, etc.

= still be present because everything else has disappeared, been used, chosen, removed, etc.

剩下 ; 餘下

Examples

1. Only two cakes **remain**.

只**剩下**兩個蛋糕。

2. Several questions **remain**.

還有幾個問題**尚未解決 / 仍然存在**。

11. remaining

= still left after others have gone, been used, completed, etc.

剩餘的 ; 餘下的

Examples

1. We used the **remaining time** to revise.

我們利用**剩餘時間**溫習。

2. The **remaining students** left after lunch.

其餘學生午飯後離開。

Work still to be done

12. remain to be done

= still need to be done

仍有待完成

Examples

1. Much work **remains to be done**.

還有大量工作**有待完成**。

2. Several issues **remain to be resolved**.

還有幾個問題**有待解決**。

Very high-value formal construction.

13. remain unresolved / unanswered

= continue without being resolved or answered

仍未解決；仍未有答案

Examples

1. The problem **remains unresolved**.

問題**仍未解決**。

2. Several questions **remain unanswered**.

還有幾個問題**仍未得到解答**。

Remain to be seen

14. remain to be seen

= not yet known; will only become clear later

仍有待觀察；尚未可知

Examples

1. Whether the plan will work ****remains to be seen****.
這個計畫是否有效****仍有待觀察****。
2. It ****remains to be seen**** how students will respond.
學生會如何反應****尚未可知****。

Extremely high-value expression.

Remain the same / remain a mystery

15. remain + noun

= continue to be a particular thing

****仍然是；依然是****

Examples

1. She ****remains a close friend****.
她****仍然是****我的好友。
2. The reason ****remains a mystery****.
原因****仍然是個謎****。

Useful grammar pattern:

> ****remain + noun****

> → ****仍然是.....****

Remain relevant / important / true

16. remain — continue to have a quality

= continue to be relevant, important, true, useful, etc.

****仍然；依然保持****

Examples

1. The lesson ****remains relevant**** today.
這堂課的內容今天****仍然適用****。
2. Her advice ****remains useful****.
她的建議****依然有用****。

This belongs to the same linking-verb sense as **remain silent**.

What remains

17. what remains

= what is still left or still exists

剩下的部分；餘下的事物

Examples

1. We need to decide what to do with **what remains**.

我們需要決定如何處理**剩下的部分**。

2. **What remains** is difficult to identify.

餘下的部分很難辨認。

REMAINS

18. remains — what is left of something

Plural noun:

= parts left after most of something has disappeared, been destroyed, decayed, used, etc.

遺跡；殘餘；殘骸

Examples

1. Archaeologists discovered the **remains of an ancient settlement**.

考古學家發現了一處古代聚落的**遺跡**。

2. Only the **remains of the building** were visible.

只看得到那棟建築的**殘骸**。

Major distinct noun use.

19. human remains

= dead person's body or parts of a body, especially in formal, archaeological, forensic, or disaster

contexts

****遺體；遺骸****

Examples

1. Investigators discovered ****human remains****.
調查人員發現了****人類遺骸****。
2. The ****remains**** were identified several days later.
****遺體 / 遺骸****數日後確認了身分。

Important:

> ****remains****

> here does not simply mean “remaining things.”

It is a lexicalized formal term for a body or bodily remains.

20. archaeological remains

= physical traces, ruins, objects, structures, etc. surviving from earlier societies

****考古遺跡；遺存****

Examples

1. The site contains important ****archaeological remains****.
該遺址包含重要的****考古遺存****。
2. Ancient ****remains**** were found beneath the building.
大樓下方發現了古代****遺跡****。

Remainder

21. remainder

= part that is left after the rest has been used, removed, completed, divided, etc.

****剩餘部分；餘下部分****

Examples

1. We spent the ****remainder of the day**** at home.
我們那天****餘下的時間****都留在家裡。

2. The **remainder** was divided equally.

剩餘部分被平均分配。

Useful family neighbor.

22. the remainder of

= the part of a period, amount, group, etc. that is still left

其餘；剩餘的.....

Examples

1. She stayed for **the remainder of the lesson**.

她在**餘下的課堂時間**都留下來。

2. The weather stayed dry for **the remainder of the week**.

這星期餘下的時間天氣一直乾燥。

Mathematical remainder

23. remainder — mathematics

= amount left over when one number cannot be divided exactly by another

餘數

Examples

1. Ten divided by three leaves a **remainder** of one.

十除以三，**餘數**是一。

2. Find the **remainder**.

找出**餘數**。

Distinct established family sense.

Remaining

24. remaining — left over

= still present after the rest have gone, been used, completed, etc.

****剩下的；餘下的****

Examples

1. The ****remaining money**** was returned.

****剩餘的錢****被退回。

2. Finish the ****remaining questions****.

完成****餘下的問題****。

Key constructions

25. remain calm

= continue to be calm

****保持冷靜****

26. remain silent

= continue not speaking

****保持沉默****

This is the passage construction.

27. remain open

Can mean:

A. physically not closed

****保持開著****

> The door remained open.

> 門一直開著。

B. continue operating / available

****繼續營業 / 開放****

> The shop will remain open until ten.

> 商店會**繼續營業**到十點。

C. issue not decided

仍未有定論

> The question remains open.

> 這個問題**仍未有定論**。

A useful example of one grammatical pattern producing different contextual Chinese.

28. remain in place

= stay where something currently is

留在原位；保持不動

Examples

1. Please **remain in place**.

請**留在原位**。

2. The barriers will **remain in place** overnight.

這些屏障整晚都會**保持在原位**。

Key contrasts

29. remain vs stay

stay

= common everyday word meaning continue in a place/state

留在；保持

remain

= similar but often more formal and especially common in written/analytical English

仍然；保持；留下

Compare:

> Stay calm.

> 保持冷靜。

- > Remain calm.
- > 保持冷靜。(較正式)

30. remain vs continue

****continue****

= keep doing an activity or keep happening

****繼續****

****remain****

= keep ****being in a state/place****

****仍然 / 保持****

Compare:

- > continue talking
- > 繼續說話

- > remain silent
- > 保持沉默

Usually:

- >  remain talking

is not the normal equivalent of ****continue talking****.

31. remain vs keep

****keep****

can mean actively maintain a state:

- > keep the door open
- > 讓門保持開著

****remain****

usually describes the subject continuing in that state:

- > the door remained open
- > 門一直開著

So:

****keep****

→ often causes/maintains

****remain****

→ continues to be

32. remain vs leave

These can become opposites in place contexts:

****remain****

= stay

****留下****

****leave****

= go away

****離開****

Compare:

> Two students remained.

> 兩名學生留了下來。

> The others left.

> 其他人離開了。

33. remain vs left

****remain****

= verb

****剩下；仍在****

****left****

= adjective/past participle commonly expressing what remains

****剩下的****

Compare:

> Three cakes remain.

> 還剩三個蛋糕。

> There are three cakes left.

> 還剩三個蛋糕。

The meaning is often nearly identical.

34. remains vs remainder

****remains****

= surviving physical parts/traces, or a dead body

****遺跡；殘骸；遺體****

****remainder****

= ordinary leftover portion of an amount, period, group, or mathematical division

****餘下部分；餘數****

Compare:

> remains of an ancient building

> 古建築遺跡

> remainder of the day

> 餘下的一天

Meaning map

The central concept of ****remain**** is:

****continue to be there or continue to be in the same condition after time passes or other things change****

From this develop:

A. Continue in a state

Passage

remain silent

→ ****保持沉默****

Emotion

remain calm

→ **保持冷靜**

Condition

remain unchanged

→ **保持不變**

B. Stay in a place

Person

remain in the room

→ **留在房間**

C. Continue to exist

Tradition

tradition remains

→ **傳統仍然存在**

Building

few buildings remain

→ **只剩幾棟建築**

D. Be left

Quantity

two cakes remain

→ **剩下兩個蛋糕**

Work

work remains to be done

→ **工作仍有待完成**

Uncertainty

remains to be seen

→ **仍有待觀察**

E. What survives

Physical remnants

remains of a building

→ **建築殘骸 / 遺跡**

Body

human remains

→ **遺體 / 遺骸**

The common thread is extremely stable:

something is still there after something else has changed, passed, disappeared, or finished.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
remain + adjective	繼續處於某種狀態；仍然 / 保持.....
remain silent	繼續不說話；保持沉默
remain calm	繼續保持冷靜
remain unchanged	保持不變
remain unclear/unknown	仍然不清楚 / 未知
remain — stay somewhere	不離開某處；留下 / 繼續待在
remain at/in/with	留在某地 / 某人身邊
remain — continue to exist	經過一段時間後仍然存在 / 保留下來
remain — be left	其他部分消失、用完等之後仍然剩下
remaining	尚未用完、離開或完成的；剩餘 / 餘下的
remain to be done	某工作仍然需要完成；有待完成
remain unresolved/unanswered	問題仍未解決 / 問題仍未得到回答
remain to be seen	結果目前還不知道；仍有待觀察
remain + noun	繼續是某種身分 / 事物
what remains	仍然剩下 / 存在的部分
remains — surviving parts	事物毀壞、消失後留下的殘骸 / 遺跡
human remains	正式：死者的遺體 / 遺骸

archaeological remains	從古代保存下來的考古遺跡 / 遺存	
remainder — leftover part	使用、完成、分配後餘下的部分	
the remainder of	某段時間、數量等其餘 / 餘下部分	
remainder — mathematics	除法不能整除時剩下的餘數	
remain open — physically	繼續開著、沒有關閉	
remain open — business/access	繼續營業 / 開放	
remain open — question	問題仍未解決 / 仍未有定論	
remain in place	繼續留在原位、不移動	

Passage recap

> “...different classmates had to decide whether to laugh along, ****remain silent**** or speak up.”

Here:

****remain**** = ****to continue to be in the same state****

And:

****remain silent****

= ****continue not speaking****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****保持沉默****

* ****繼續不作聲****

Natural contextual translation:

****不同的同學必須決定，是要跟著一起笑、保持沉默，還是挺身發聲。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****remain****

= ****to continue to be in a particular state or condition****

****仍然；保持****

In the passage:

> ****remain silent****

> → ****保持沉默****

The biggest learner splits are:

> **remain calm**

> → **保持冷靜**

> **remain in the room**

> → **留在房間**

> **only two remain**

> → **只剩兩個**

> **the problem remains unresolved**

> → 問題**仍未解決**

> **it remains to be seen**

> → **仍有待觀察 / 尚未可知**

and the noun changes considerably:

> **remains of the building**

> → 建築的**遺跡 / 殘骸**

> **human remains**

> → **遺體 / 遺骸**

A particularly useful grammatical distinction is:

> **continue talking**

> → **繼續說話**

but:

> **remain silent**

> → **保持沉默**

So **remain** typically describes **continuing to be in a state or place**, whereas **continue** more freely describes **continuing an action**.

In the passage, the choice to **remain silent** is therefore not an active speaking behavior—it means **continuing not to intervene**, which is exactly why the drama exercise treats silence itself as a meaningful choice.